



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Market Planning

BUSINESS SERVICES MARKETING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of market and market identification.
2. Explain the nature of marketing plans.
3. Explain the role of situation analysis in the marketing planning process.
4. Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.
5. Identify communications channels used in sales promotion.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the marketing director for FESTIVE FINDS, a company that specializes in holiday decorations and seasonal home décor. The company has been struggling recently, with increased competition from online retailers and a decline in physical store sales. The CEO (judge) wants you to create a marketing plan to revitalize the business by focusing on a younger, more trend-driven customer base.

FESTIVE FINDS has historically catered to older homeowners, but now the CEO (judge) believes that millennials and Gen Z—who are active on social media and love unique, personalized holiday décor—could be key to driving new sales. The challenge is repositioning the brand to appeal to this audience without alienating its existing customer base.

FESTIVE FINDS specializes in a wide range of seasonal and holiday décor, offering products that help customers create festive atmospheres for celebrations throughout the year. Their product line includes Christmas tree ornaments, holiday wreaths, and garlands, as well as table centerpieces, outdoor inflatables, and decorative lighting. FESTIVE FINDS also provides customizable items like personalized stockings, engraved tree toppers, and seasonal home décor pieces that cater to various holidays, including Halloween, Thanksgiving, Easter, and more. Known for their high-quality craftsmanship, the company focuses on creating timeless, traditional pieces with a modern touch.

The CEO (judge) has asked you to develop a marketing plan that includes strategies for social media marketing, influencer partnerships, and creating limited-edition, customizable holiday décor. The CEO wants to ensure that the brand remains focused on quality and tradition while embracing modern trends.

You will present your marketing plan to the CEO (judge) in a role-play to take place in the CEO's office. The CEO (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented the plan and answered the CEO's (judge's) questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do you plan to differentiate FESTIVE FINDS from the many online retailers that already cater to a younger demographic, especially when it comes to pricing and convenience?
2. What strategies do you have in place to handle potential pushback from loyal customers who may not respond well to a shift towards trendier, more modern décor styles?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of market and market identification?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain the nature of marketing plans?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the role of situation analysis in the marketing planning process?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Explain factors that influence customer/client/business buying behavior.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Identify communications channels used in sales promotion?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						